Alcovia – Product, Systems & Analytics Lead: my approach

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I'd spend my first 8 weeks (from 1 Nov) on three things, in this order: getting students to actually use the app, giving the founders a GTM tracker they can trust (live by week 3), and replacing the weekly student docs with one dashboard (live by week 8). Prototypes: GTM tracker and student tracker. More detail and diagrams: full plan. The GitHub repo is linked in the form.

How I'd split the team

- **Me:** decide what we build and why, set the metric for each piece of work, write specs, and talk to students, parents and advisors.
- **Engineer:** app work only. With one engineer, this is our tightest constraint, so I don't want them pulled into dashboards or automations.
- **Process designer:** ClickUp clean-up, n8n automations, the GTM dashboard (doable without code), Smallest.ai call flows and SOPs.

1. App usage (2.15 min a day, target 30)

I installed the app and went through it as a new student. It took me about 22 taps of intro screens and tooltips before I could do anything. The Realm game is fun, but studying doesn't feed into it, and some screens use terms like "Daily Velocity 1.33%" that a 15-year-old won't connect with.

My fix is to build the app around one daily routine: open the app, see today's one task, run a focus session on it, earn something in the Realm, and see how your pod is doing. That means shorter onboarding, a simpler home screen, the 8pm quiz inside the app, and rankings within a pod of 5 friends instead of all 20 students. I'd aim for 10 minutes a day by end of November, 20 by December and 30 by January. With only 20 students, I'd judge changes by weekly trends and by talking to students, not by A/B tests.

2. GTM tracker

One page with a date filter. It shows revenue against target (trial vs full program, workshops at ₹3,999, unpaid invoices, upcoming trial renewals), the Meta funnel from lead to paid with show-up and drop-off at each stage, and which ads to scale, refresh or drop. My rule for ads: if the same people have seen an ad 3+ times or fewer than 1% click it, refresh it; if it costs far more than target per lead, drop it.

n8n pulls data from Razorpay, ClickUp and Meta into one database every night. I'd also use Smallest.ai, which Alcovia already has, to call parents before discovery calls and before trials end. All numbers in the prototype are dummy except the ₹3,999 seat price.

3. Making sure what we build actually works

Every piece of work goes through the same steps: agree on one metric and a target date, check with about 5 users that the problem is real, test a simple mock-up with 3 users, build it with tracking included, release to a small group first, then check the metric weekly and decide whether to scale it, improve it or stop. For me, a feature isn't done when it ships; it's done when the number moves. Week to week: plan on Monday, a short daily check-in, a metrics review on Friday, and a retro once a month.

4. Student dashboard

For every activity I'd ask three questions: did we do it (held vs planned), did the student like it (attendance and a one-tap rating), and did the student improve (scores, focus time, syllabus progress). For the syllabus, each chapter earns points as the student moves through the 5 stages Alcovia already uses, from reading it to being exam-ready. Advisors are measured too, because the automations only work if they enter targets and act on alerts.

Most data comes in automatically from the app, wearables, the calendar and ClickUp; exam scores are the only regular manual entry. n8n sends advisors a nightly WhatsApp listing students who are falling behind, and parents get a short weekly summary. The phone-locking focus mode needs checking first because Apple and Google restrict it, so I'd test it in week 1 and build it in January if it works.

Risks I'm watching: advisors not keeping data up to date (so I measure their inputs too), and the engineer getting overloaded (so anything that can be built without code is).

Weeks	Me	Engineer	Process designer
1	Set metrics; interview 6 students	Fix app tracking; check focus mode	Set up ClickUp funnel stages and n8n data feeds
2–3	Write app specs	New onboarding and home screen	GTM tracker live; Smallest.ai calls
4–5	Test with 5 students; design student dashboard	Focus-to-reward loop, quiz, pods	Clean up student data; rating forms
6–8	Review results and decide next steps	Wearable data; student dashboard	Advisor training; parent summary